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Iconiq's Will Griffith explains how his firm celebrated Figma's IPO and why investors sold shares



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A wide panoramic photograph showing three people in the foreground looking out at a large crowd of people seated in a large hall. The scene is dimly lit with a bright light source in the background.

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Series A. And Griffith wrote more checks as Figma raised additional rounds. The company raised a total of about \$332 million in venture funding through 2024, PitchBook estimates.

"We invested in the seed. We invested in the Series A. We invested further. We did some secondary and we also invested more meaningfully a year ago," Griffith said.

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40 times oversubscribed, according to Bloomberg, meaning far more investors wanted shares than the supply available.

That can be almost as problematic as investor disinterest, Griffith explained. The largest institutional investors won't bother with an IPO where they can't trade hundreds of millions' worth of shares, he said. And if an IPO doesn't float



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enough shares, prices of available shares could become artificially inflated, meaning the company won't be properly valued. Should prices decline after opening day, the company could be artificially devalued as well.

Figma's existing shareholders didn't really want to sell shares at \$33, Griffith said. "We have been with this business since 2015, and we haven't sold a share. And we are going to be meaningful buyers in the IPO."

Still, Griffith said, "It's just a matter of time." He said, "Hill, Field, P grow, but authentic."

In the next PO day founder

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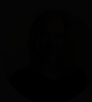
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That means demand for shares is 40x the number of shares the company and its existing investors are selling. So it should surprise no one that Figma, which offers design software, has priced its initial shares at \$33 per share, above its previously announced range.

On Monday, the company said its expected price range was \$30 to \$32, up from a previously announced range of \$25 to \$28. At the final \$33 price, the offering raised \$1.2 billion. Most of that money is going to existing shareholders who are selling about twice as many shares (including founder and CEO Dylan Field) as the company itself has offered.

The IPO price values Figma at \$19.3 billion, CNBC

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